Platform Evaluation Sheet 1-ChatGPT

Platform Name: ChatGPT
Interface (web/app/extension): OpenAI chatgpt.com
Date/Time & Version: September Plus GPT-5.6 SOL 25, 26 & 27th;

Scoring Rubric

Category	Criteria	Definition & Evaluation Focus	Score (0-3)	Note
I. Pedagogical Relevance & Performance	1. Pedagogical Alignment & Usefulness	The extent to which the tool's AI capabilities support specific educational objectives and solve a defined problem for educators or students. Evaluation Focus: Clarity of objectives, match between AI functionalities and educational tasks, and potential for beneficial uses.	3	The lesson plan provided was detailed, provided accurate examples, and discussed how it would ensure students identify what went wrong, not allowing them to only replace an incorrect answer. I would score this a 3 as it is the most thorough and detailed, and the most accurate out of all three lesson plans provided
	2. Accuracy & Content Quality	The degree to which AI-generated content (text, images, code, etc.) is consistently correct, reliable, relevant, and meaningful. Evaluation Focus: Verifiability, absence of misinformation, and relevance of content.	3	I requested the AI provide examples of what it would teach and show incorrect vs. correct samples to verify if the AI knew the correct logic. In this it performed rather well and showed how it would teach students to identify the errors and correct them. The content was relevant, free of errors and misinformation, and that earned its three.
	3. Ease of Use & User Experience	The simplicity and intuitiveness of the user interface, allowing for effective use with minimal training. Evaluation Focus: User-friendly interface, minimal learning curve, efficient task completion, and user satisfaction.	3	ChatGPT is the only one out of all three interfaces reviewed that offers a “Study Mode” specifically for student use. The response stated: “Study Mode is specifically designed to guide students through material rather than simply

				supply answers. It can ask questions, provide hints, check understanding, explain mistakes, and create quizzes and practice exercises." This makes the ease of use and user experience the best option out of all three evaluated. Since this platform has an active format ready to be deployed for student use, I give this section a 3.
II. Ethical & Responsible AI	4. Bias Mitigation & Fairness	The extent to which the tool mitigates harmful biases and ensures equitable treatment across different groups. Evaluation Focus: Absence of stereotypical or discriminatory outputs, efforts to manage biases, and alignment with concepts of equality and justice.	3	The tool attempts to avoid assigning genders to professions or students and calls out that it would provide sentences to cite that reflect a diverse society. "For example, we should not repeatedly present scientists as men, nurses as women, affluent students as academically successful, or certain racial or cultural groups primarily in examples about poverty or crime." The three has been earned through its acknowledgement of bias and its mitigation strategies which are multi-layered.
	5. Privacy & Data Security	The measures taken to protect user data, maintain confidentiality, and comply with privacy regulations. Evaluation Focus: Explicit privacy policy, use of encryption, and compliance with regulations like FERPA or HIPAA.	2	ChatGPT called out they would use the minimum data rule, and that "customer data is encrypted in transit and at rest using TLS 1.2 or higher in transit and AES-256 at rest." It states that Open AI *supports* customers compliance with FERPA- which is different than being independently FERPA compliant. It also called out "the current ChatGPT for Teachers offering is specifically for teachers and school staff, not students.

				OpenAI describes it as having FERPA-aligned protections and a student data privacy agreement but explicitly states that the plan is not currently for student accounts". Because it has relatively solid privacy options, but not concrete FERPA or HIPAA compliance language, here it loses a point and earns it a 2.
	6. Transparency & Explainability	The degree to which information about the AI system's mechanisms, outputs, and decision-making processes is available and understandable. Evaluation Focus: Clear documentation of training data and sources, and ability to understand how the AI functions.	2	In this section, ChatGPT provided the best answers seen, but there is still some room left to be desired, as is with all AI products. It provided an example of an auditable decision framework that it would be willing to provide throughout the coursework, something we did not see in the other two options. The details on how it was trained were more in depth: "OpenAI says its foundation models are developed from three main categories of information: publicly available information, information accessed through third-party partnerships, and information provided or generated by users, human trainers, and researchers." But still lacking. Finally, once again, the AI model stated it did not utilize reference or source documentation to know the rules for APA guidelines, but it did provide source documentation to what it would use in an active course. The decision tree that would be provided and is auditable is what bumped this score up to earning it a 2.

	7. Accessibility	How easily users with diverse abilities can use the tool. Evaluation Focus: Support for screen readers, compliance with web accessibility standards, and ease of use for individuals with different needs.	3	ChatGPT has a voice feature that students can speak and hear responses, and those items will also appear as text. It also supports teaching students in multiple languages. It can speak to the student in one language and follow it up with the English version for the student to see both, a major benefit for English language learners. It also supports shorter lessons for those with spotty internet connections so they may complete short quick lessons in between service interruptions. The detailed list of accessibility options has earned this section a 3.
III. Practical & Operational Aspects	8. Cost & Value (ROI)	The financial expense balanced against its quantifiable and qualitative benefits. Evaluation Focus: Transparency of costs (fees, setup) and expected return on investment in terms of time saved or improved learning outcomes.	2	In monetary terms, the chat provided a charted budgeted breakdown amounting to $2,700-$7,300 for implementation – then researched the APA's official digital Mastering APA Style Student Workbook- which for the same number of students budgeted to $4,799–$5,999 and included details on what that includes. A great comparison tool right in the answer. For teacher hours: "Across three teachers for eight weeks: Low estimate: 3 teachers × 2 hours × 8 weeks = 48 teacher hours returned Higher target:

				3 × 4 × 8 = 96 teacher hours returned The teacher can spend the reclaimed time on: Students requiring intervention • individual writing conferences • deeper feedback on students' arguments • lesson preparation • parent communication • IEP/504 responsibilities • cross-curricular planning • students who are significantly behind • advanced students needing greater challenge." It did not attempt to provide an unknown answer to how much learning outcomes will improve or the increase in student confidence, but it did provide useful tools to measure both of those items before and after the training is completed. Since I cannot confidently say this is wonderful and the best as a non-educator, I squarely placed this in the good category at a 2.
	9. Integration & Scalability	The ability of the tool to integrate with existing systems and handle increasing amounts of work, data, or users without performance drops. Evaluation Focus: Compatibility with other software, availability of APIs, and performance with large user bases.	2	Supports API calls, but through Open AI's API, not a 3rd party. It does not have native integration into other LMS tools. It can connect to a few tools, GDrive and SharePoint. <- good for course content! So, API calls will be the best bet, although IT will be needed to assist to ensure the connection is smooth, which can drive up implementation cost and hinders scalability. There are upload limitations that can hinder scaling as well- 25GB of

				storage for user, 100GB for organization. It is okay for a pilot program, and may require additional licensing for longer term projects, earning it a 2.
	10. Vendor Support & Updates	The availability and quality of technical support, customer service, and ongoing maintenance. Evaluation Focus: Access to support teams, responsiveness to feedback, and clear update schedules.	2	Product updates are published, there is technical support but not a guaranteed support person or team, there is a feedback mechanism but not guaranteed feedback response time. Requests for support are through the chat center starting with a virtual agent and maybe routed to a human. There is training on Open AI through their academy's education resources to assist with onboarding. Administrators have the option to turn off automatic desktop-app updates to avoid disruption but warns of security risks in doing so, leaving the schools responsible for deploying security fixes. It reiterates that it would not train the model on the student's input for privacy reasons. Much of the vendor support sections have been highlighted as an option to review within the contract signing phase for optionality. This leaves other possibilities open, but no guarantees. Because most of the information is sufficient, this garners it a 2, however it is not above and beyond for educators, not having a direct tech support line for educators to contact is a major drawback, which is why it could not earn the third point.

TOTAL SCORE	25	

- Top 2 strengths: Accessibility & Cost & Value (ROI): The accessibility options are the best out of all the options evaluated. They are robust and applicable to multiple students, improving equitable access to education. The Cost is roughly a quarter of what was quoted for Copilot, and the estimated value on teachers' time is significant. Running studies on how much time it actually saves will be important to verify this information, as it is currently an estimated assumption.
- Top 2 limitations: Transparency & Explainability and Vendor Support & Updates: The limitations on how the model was trained and not referencing source material is something that will need to be addressed in a contract with OpenAI, to ensure there is transparency on what documentation can and cannot be sourced from during the students training. Not having a dedicated vendor support line, even if it is a wide vendor support for all educators, is a major drawback. Particularly when launching a pilot program, support from the supplier is key. This is another area to discuss during a contract phase.
- Overall recommendation for educators: This is a promising option worth exploring. The study feature is available, but as with all AI products, additional testing throughout and due diligence is imperative.

Platform Evaluation Sheet 2-Claude

Platform Name: Claude
Interface (web/app/extension): Anthropic Free claude.ai
Date/Time & Version: September 25, 26 & 27th; Sonnet 5,

Scoring Rubric

Category	Criteria	Definition & Evaluation Focus	Score (0-3)	Note
I. Pedagogical Relevance & Performance	1. Pedagogical Alignment & Usefulness	The extent to which the tool's AI capabilities support specific educational objectives and solve a defined problem for educators or students. Evaluation Focus: Clarity of objectives, match between AI functionalities and educational tasks, and potential for beneficial uses.	1	The sample lesson plan provided through claude was the weakest of all three. This was in 4 chunks instead of an 8-week defined plan. It hit on some key topics (I do, we do, you do), but the overall detail was underwhelming. A significant amount of prompt refining would be needed to get this to a place that would be sufficient to implement, and that is why it earned a 1.
	2. Accuracy & Content Quality	The degree to which AI-generated content (text, images, code, etc.) is consistently correct, reliable, relevant, and meaningful. Evaluation Focus: Verifiability, absence of misinformation, and relevance of content.	2	Claude was consistent throughout; however, it consistently mentioned that this is not a tool for students under 18. The content was relevant, and when I asked for example citations, it provided some incorrect citations, with " " inside the citation itself. I'm scoring this at a 2 looking at the conversation holistically, as it provided consistent information, did not contradict itself, but removing a point for the single error I found.
	3. Ease of Use & User Experience	The simplicity and intuitiveness of the user interface, allowing for effective use with minimal training.	0	Claude called out that it is not intended for students or children under the age of 18. It can be used for teachers to help create the lesson plans but would require

		Evaluation Focus: User-friendly interface, minimal learning curve, efficient task completion, and user satisfaction.		additional approval channels and reviews if this system were to be implemented as a learning tool for students. This makes Claude the worst option to use as a direct platform for students to use directly out of all three options. Since it is not designed for any use by high school students, I give this section a 0.
II. Ethical & Responsible AI	4. Bias Mitigation & Fairness	The extent to which the tool mitigates harmful biases and ensures equitable treatment across different groups. Evaluation Focus: Absence of stereotypical or discriminatory outputs, efforts to manage biases, and alignment with concepts of equality and justice.	3	I really liked the straightforward response to the second half of the prompt. “No AI system, including Claude, can be guaranteed bias-free. Bias in language models typically comes from patterns in the enormous amount of text used in training, and some of that reflects biases that exist in the real world. Anthropic reduces this — it doesn't eliminate it.” It also provided additional detailed steps to check the tool on its bias. Claude earned a 3 for its stark honesty and basing any differentiators of learning on skills and prior knowledge-not culture and ethnic backgrounds.
	5. Privacy & Data Security	The measures taken to protect user data, maintain confidentiality, and comply with privacy regulations. Evaluation Focus: Explicit privacy policy, use of encryption, and compliance with regulations like FERPA or HIPAA.	0	Data privacy in Claude with students is high risk. Claude directly states: “The consumer privacy policy doesn't establish FERPA or COPPA school-official terms, and the services aren't directed to children under 18. If a teacher just opens a personal Claude account and starts putting student names or work into it, that is very likely a compliance problem, not a solution.” Immediately, this earns Claude

				a 0 in data privacy and would not be recommended (similar to what we found through the user experience prompt, but more concrete on the data privacy aspect.)
	6. Transparency & Explainability	The degree to which information about the AI system's mechanisms, outputs, and decision-making processes is available and understandable. Evaluation Focus: Clear documentation of training data and sources, and ability to understand how the AI functions.	1	I may be overly critical in this area, however both transparency and data privacy evaluated above are critical aspects that should not be taken lightly. Claude could not provide me source documentation that the AI pulled from to establish knowledge of APA formatting, however it was able to provide the sources of APA formatting- reading that fast sounds similar but they are vastly different. In the first, it would have provided concrete evidence of the tool's knowledge base. In the latter, it is saying here are the resources, but I did not refer to them or use them to show I know what APA formatting is. If the tool had done that, it might have received a more favorable score. The AI also could not provide detailed information beyond "a very large amount of text" that it was trained on. It could not provide an internal decision log. All these factors earned this section a score of 1.
	7. Accessibility	How easily users with diverse abilities can use the tool. Evaluation Focus: Support for screen readers, compliance with web accessibility standards, and ease of use for individuals with different needs.	1	Claude off the bat here had the understanding it was for assessing the AI tool itself, unlike Co-pilot. There is not text to speech feature in Claude. Screen readers are compatible with the interface. It does support

				multiple languages, but it must be explicitly requested. It “has almost no built-in infrastructure for automatically detecting needs, remembering them across sessions, or delivering them through specialized accessibility channels”. The accessibility accommodations are severely lacking for Claude and earns it a 1. It did not get a 0 because it does have the ability to support multiple languages/simplified English and is compatible with screen readers. The rest leaves something to be desired. Note-the second part of the prompt was not needed here, as it did not incorrectly assume it was a generic ask. Another reason to earn it a 1 instead of a 0- although that falls more into the accuracy category.
III. Practical & Operational Aspects	8. Cost & Value (ROI)	The financial expense balanced against its quantifiable and qualitative benefits. Evaluation Focus: Transparency of costs (fees, setup) and expected return on investment in terms of time saved or improved learning outcomes.	0	For implementation of a student facing interface, there is no viable ROI, as it repeated that users under 18 are prohibited from using Claude, and the platform would not be feasible for this implementation. Approximate cost breakdowns were not provided for any part of the process, except the teacher licensing, which is free for the first 2 years, but could not provide a cost for the years after that. This was scored as a 0 for the lack of feasibility of implementation and no foreseeable ROI.

	9. Integration & Scalability	The ability of the tool to integrate with existing systems and handle increasing amounts of work, data, or users without performance drops. Evaluation Focus: Compatibility with other software, availability of APIs, and performance with large user bases.	1	Claude is set up for a connection with Canvas- where ChatGPT is not, however it is aimed at administrators of Claude for Education, meant for higher-education levels, not necessarily high schools. Their API is publicly available, so links can occur that way. To make open API calls, a developer's license is required, which is a separate payment. It did not provide a detailed upload limitation like ChatGPT did, instead provided the standard rough token limit, 200,000- which does not provide enough information. With the lack of information and extra licensing fees required for this to scale, I would give this a 1.
	10. Vendor Support & Updates	The availability and quality of technical support, customer service, and ongoing maintenance. Evaluation Focus: Access to support teams, responsiveness to feedback, and clear update schedules.	1	For technical support, there is a setup guide inside of a help center. No mention of a way to contact support teams. There are AI-fluency courses for teachers to understand the platform better within its K-12 Academy (ironic-K-12 academy for teachers but no students allowed to use the platform). It could not provide a published update schedule to track outages or updates to the software. No indication on how often feedback is acted on, and the Thumbs up/thumbs down seems to be the best feedback option. The presence of a help center and a K-12 academy earns this 1 point, and much left to be desired.

TOTAL SCORE	10	

- Top 2 strengths: Bias and Accuracy: The detailed steps to check Claude for bias made it a strong point; they evaluate “model outputs across different demographic groups, conduct red teaming for stereotyping, and train the model to avoid making assumptions based on race, gender, disability status, and similar traits”. The accuracy and quality of outputs remained consistent throughout the interaction, and the tool did not try to provide a solution for the task it could not responsibly complete.
- Top 2 limitations: Data Privacy and Cost & Value (ROI): There is no ROI, as this platform is not made for students under 18, so the value does not exist. There are no FERPA terms with Claude, and it warns of compliance issues if students’ information is added to the platform.
- Overall recommendation for educators: I would not recommend this platform for educators, as it does not permit students under the age of 18 on its platform.

Platform Evaluation Sheet 3-Copilot

Platform Name: Microsoft Copilot
Interface (web/app/extension): Microsoft Copilot, copilot.com
Date/Time & Version: September 25, 26 & 27th; Version: Personal, Service version 2.20260924.61.0. Environment Production

Scoring Rubric

Category	Criteria	Definition & Evaluation Focus	Score (0-3)	Note
I. Pedagogical Relevance & Performance	1. Pedagogical Alignment & Usefulness	The extent to which the tool's AI capabilities support specific educational objectives and solve a defined problem for educators or students. Evaluation Focus: Clarity of objectives, match between AI functionalities and educational tasks, and potential for beneficial uses.	2	Copilot had a decently well-defined lesson plan, but there were some errors in their examples. A citation example was missing the quotations- leaving question on how well AI could teach the students proper citations if the examples were lacking. Otherwise, it is sufficient and has a well detailed plan, so it could be a decent option, but not the best, hence I have scored it as a 2.
	2. Accuracy & Content Quality	The degree to which AI-generated content (text, images, code, etc.) is consistently correct, reliable, relevant, and meaningful. Evaluation Focus: Verifiability, absence of misinformation, and relevance of content.	2	This is the only one out of all three within the same context window that kept dropping it was being assessed. After reasserting twice that the evaluation was on copilot itself, it seemed to course correct. Aside from that, copilot provided relevant and meaningful information, and when asked to provide examples of correct and incorrect citations to check the accuracy of copilot, it did so with additional context that would be helpful for students. The content quality and accuracy are sufficient to earn it a 2 but

				loses its final point though the missing context later in the conversation.
	3. Ease of Use & User Experience	The simplicity and intuitiveness of the user interface, allowing for effective use with minimal training. Evaluation Focus: User-friendly interface, minimal learning curve, efficient task completion, and user satisfaction.	2	Copilot uses the most visual aspects out of all three in its interface through the use of emojis. The response showed: "What AI Can Easily Provide Text-based rewards such as: ✅ Correct! 🏆 Citation Master ⭐ Perfect Score 🎉 Excellent Work" Copilot does not: "independently create student accounts, maintain a gradebook, track completion across multiple days, or generate visual reward animations unless those capabilities are provided by the platform hosting me. For an administrator evaluation, I would propose the following model." For the level of friction that would add more work onto the teacher, I would deduct a point, giving it a 2.
II. Ethical & Responsible AI	4. Bias Mitigation & Fairness	The extent to which the tool mitigates harmful biases and ensures equitable treatment across different groups. Evaluation Focus: Absence of stereotypical or discriminatory outputs,	3	In the second part of the prompt, I liked how co-pilot provided an example of the type of citation they would use- "Sea turtles migrate long distances.", vs. wouldn't use- "During my family's ski trip to Aspen..." to avoid unintentional bias or harm to the

		efforts to manage biases, and alignment with concepts of equality and justice.		students by keeping the language neutral. The AI decides and adapts the learning program based on: “Quiz scores Error patterns Speed of mastery Number of attempts needed Types of mistakes made For example, if a student repeatedly forgets to include publication years, the AI can automatically provide extra practice focused on years. “ The use of neutral educational based examples and adaptation focused only on how the student is doing academically earns this a 3.
	5. Privacy & Data Security	The measures taken to protect user data, maintain confidentiality, and comply with privacy regulations. Evaluation Focus: Explicit privacy policy, use of encryption, and compliance with regulations like FERPA or HIPAA.	3	Starting off strong, “Microsoft states that Copilot operates within the Microsoft 365 service boundary and respects existing permissions, access controls, sensitivity labels, and compliance protections”, this is the only one out of all three that offers an option to keep student data within a closed network environment. That closed network is defined as “Within the school’s-controlled Microsoft 365 tenant”. FERPA is also mentioned here, and using contractual commitments, designations relevant to FERPA-covered requirements, they can support schools in FERPA compliance but highlights a school’s responsibility for evaluation and

				implementation of compliance requirements. Copilot earned a 3 in this category and shows the best commitment to student data privacy out of all three options considered.
	6. Transparency & Explainability	The degree to which information about the AI system's mechanisms, outputs, and decision-making processes is available and understandable. Evaluation Focus: Clear documentation of training data and sources, and ability to understand how the AI functions.	1	Transparency of sources and training data were not provided by the tool- I followed up to specifically ask what they were referencing to know APA guidelines; the system did not provide any insights into their training documentation and did not provide reference documentation. The reason this scored a 1, and not a 0 is because it did provide examples of how the internal logic would work for selecting examples and a general overview of the training process.
	7. Accessibility	How easily users with diverse abilities can use the tool. Evaluation Focus: Support for screen readers, compliance with web accessibility standards, and ease of use for individuals with different needs.	2	Copilot can support multiple languages, screen readers, possibly text to speech with other applications combined, and possibly high contrast with other applications combined. It is sufficient but there are areas for improvement. Since this lacks an integrated voice option, one point was deducted, earning it a 2.
III. Practical & Operational Aspects	8. Cost & Value (ROI)	The financial expense balanced against its quantifiable and qualitative benefits. Evaluation Focus: Transparency of costs (fees, setup) and expected return on investment in terms of time saved or improved learning outcomes.	1	Copilot forgot it was being assessed. I added “this is for copilot” to get more accurate results. Once I added that information, I started to get results. It includes a monthly licensing fee for both students and teachers, making it the most expensive option out of all three. $28,080 for a year 120 students and 10 teachers.

				No time savings estimates were provided. This earned a 1 due to its very high costs and lack of information in the value received from paying the high costs.
	9. Integration & Scalability	The ability of the tool to integrate with existing systems and handle increasing amounts of work, data, or users without performance drops. Evaluation Focus: Compatibility with other software, availability of APIs, and performance with large user bases.	3	LMS integration is supported through "Microsoft 365 LTI (Learning Tools Interoperability)" Canvas and Blackboard Ultra are specifically mentioned. Open APIs are also supported. The data import limits are provided and are better than ChatGPT options. Their scalability and integration functions are the best with the most options, earning them a 3.
	10. Vendor Support & Updates	The availability and quality of technical support, customer service, and ongoing maintenance. Evaluation Focus: Access to support teams, responsiveness to feedback, and clear update schedules.	2	Copilot also mentions education documentation on how to use the AI tool within its support model, and no dedicated support team. Update schedules could not be located. It did mention that all offerings are guided by Responsible AI principles and standards but could not provide insight on model updates or retraining. Feedback options are the most robust on this platform, offering the option through "supported Microsoft experiences, selecting thumbs up/down, and additional comments". It states they do use the feedback to improve their products, but no timeline on how long it takes. What earns a 2 in this category for Copilot is that they do provide Education deployment guidance, suggesting at least limited dedicated technical support.

TOTAL SCORE	21	

- Top 2 strengths: Integration & Scalability and Privacy and Data Security: Since this lives within the Microsoft universe, there are extensive options for integration with other processes and scaling this rather easily. This is a major benefit. The Data Security is also a major strength due to living the Microsoft universe, mentioning its ability to support schools in FERPA compliance.
- Top 2 limitations: Accuracy and Cost & ROI: The cost to implement this platform is very high and may be out of reach for many educational institutions. This would negate the values earned and potentially place it in a negative ROI, when there are other options available to be evaluated and considered. The accuracy limitation lies in the dropping of the context window. Multiple times I had to remind Copilot that it was indeed the platform being evaluated, it seemed to forget.
- Overall recommendation for educators: It is still a decent contender, and one that could be implemented if the school district already has licensing with Microsoft that is active, but I would caution to continue evaluating the tool and completing further due diligence on ROI and accuracy measures.

Comparison & Reflection Questions

Q1: Out of the tools you tested, which platform produced the most accurate content? How did you verify sources?

A: ChatGPT consistently produced the most accurate content, with Copilot having context retention issues, and Claude providing an inaccurate citation. I verified sources by clicking on the links within the chats themselves and by pulling up each company's information page. I always click on the links provided within the chat, as that is the quickest way to see if a chat has hallucinated a source.

Q2: Which platform delivered the most concrete support for diverse needs? Provide two examples (glossaries, stems, alt text).

A: ChatGPT. This was the only one out of all three options that could provide support to those who are visually impaired through its voice application. Its ability to provide instructional support on the same topic in multiple languages to support ESL learners provides a level of equity for the students to understand requirements and be able to translate them. The support for diverse needs was impressive.

Q3: Which interface was easiest to try out and improve (editing prompts, history, export, collaboration)? Did any platform respond faster or slower than the others?

A: ChatGPT. It was at times a bit slower to respond, but it provided the most relevant information and kept the context of the conversation. In contrast, Copilot often provided very lengthy responses that included repeated answers and sometimes forgot its context, requiring the need to get back on target and spending extra time reading than should have been necessary. Claude was the most succinct in its answers, providing just enough but not too much; however, since it repeatedly said this is not built for that use case, it made it less enticing to work with.

Q4: Considering features and classroom needs, which platform offers the best value for a typical school? Would your recommendation change for an individual teacher vs. a district? Why or why not?

A: ChatGPT wins this round as well. It is significantly cheaper than Copilot, and using Claude would be a violation of their terms. I wouldn't recommend either of the other options. If I were to do this again, I would test ChatGPT against Gemini and Perplexity to see if the same holds true. For an individual teacher, ChatGPT makes the most sense. For a district, if they already have a Copilot license, the data privacy aspect and ability to scale might make Copilot a potentially better option, despite the cost increase.

Q5: Pick a winner for (a) lesson planning, (b) formative assessment, and (c) accessible materials—and justify. Use the table below to help you articulate this. Where would you avoid using GenAI and why?
A: I would avoid using GenAI at the Midpoint assessment and the Final Assessment. It is important that the students can use these skills outside of the AI platform, and testing it during

the midpoint allows for adjustments. Testing it at the end lets the teacher know if it was successful to use the platform, and if any students may need additional training or other methods of training post completion of the course.

	Lesson Planning	Formative Assessment	Accessible Materials
Winner	ChatGPT	Copilot	ChatGPT
Explanation	The lesson plan that was provided by ChatGPT was detailed and discussed how it would ask the student to identify what went wrong so they can learn from it and not just correct their answer. I provided the example below. It was the best example out of all three I saw.	This is the only platform that called out both weekly skill checks and a midpoint assessment to measure the success of the students. Copilot showed promise in this area.	This is the only platform that could support visually impaired learners, the only platform that could respond in multiple languages without being directed to before the lesson started, and the only one that didn't need additional plug ins for screen readers and simplified lessons.

Here's the high-level lesson plan ChatGPT provided:

Week	**Focus**	**What students should be able to do**
1	Why we cite sources	Explain when and why a source needs to be cited; distinguish their own ideas from information taken from a source.
2	APA in-text citations	Correctly cite a source with one author, two authors, an organization, or no named author.
3	Quoting vs. paraphrasing	Decide whether to quote or paraphrase and correctly cite both.
4	Building APA references	Create references for common sources: websites, articles, books, reports, and videos.
5	Connecting citations and references	Ensure every in-text citation has a matching reference, and every reference is actually used in the essay.
6	Finding and fixing mistakes	Edit intentionally flawed papers containing common APA errors.
7	Using APA across subjects	Practice with sources from English, history, science, and other courses so students learn that APA is not simply an English-class skill.
8	Independent application	Complete an assignment requiring students to incorporate sources and create the reference list independently.

Prompts You Created to Evaluate the Platforms

Please list the prompts you used to evaluate the platforms and indicate the alignment between the criteria and the prompt you used. Alignment of the Criteria and Tasks

Category	Criteria	Prompt You Created/Used
I. Pedagogical Relevance & Performance	1. Pedagogical Alignment & Usefulness	You have been identified as an expert in teaching high school students how to correctly incorporate APA citations and a bibliography within their essays. I am an education administrator looking to evaluate your capabilities for potential implementation in our 9th-grade English course. Our expectation by implementing your assistance is that all 9th-grade students will become experts at APA citations within 2 months and be able to take this knowledge with them throughout the remainder of their high school journey, applying it to all courses, not just English courses. Your task: 1. Generate a high-level summary of how you will accomplish this within 2 months for roughly 120 students and provide a sample mini-lesson plan directly related to the APA citations and bibliography objective. 2. Explicitly list the pedagogical strategy or framework used in your output 3. Explain how this output will complete the objective outlined above. Do not use any jargon. Keep the language clear and straightforward, in line with the expectations of the bandwidth a busy administrator has. *Using this detailed prompt set the stage for all the future prompts and to begin to understand how useful, if at all, each of the AI platforms could be in providing education on APA citations. The lesson plan sample with the high-level summary is meant to directly assess the Pedagogical Alignment.*

	2. Accuracy & Content Quality	Provide examples of citations you would use as the instructor to show the student what a correct citation is, what an incorrect citation is, and how to tell the difference. Do this for both in-text and bibliography citations. *I used this prompt to test the AI's knowledge of the APA guidelines and see if it would provide inaccurate citations. Additionally, I kept all prompts within the same context window to evaluate the entire conversation as a whole for accuracy and the quality of content provided, scoring this one last.*
	3. Ease of Use & User Experience	The training is to be completed only through this AI platform. How is it set up? How do the students access each lesson? How do they find and complete tasks, and what, if any, visual effects are used as 'rewards' upon successful completion of their classwork? *This prompt is to ensure the AI tool knows this is not a theoretical assessment but a direct one, and to see how it would play out for users. It is meant to show the steps of implementation and the visual aids for students along their learning journey.*
II. Ethical & Responsible AI	4. Bias Mitigation & Fairness	I felt it was best to split this into two parts to get a true accurate answer. 1. Will you provide different types of learning based on a student's background? 2. How will you ensure no harmful bias leaks into the training and that the training is equitable for all students? *In these two prompts, I first queried to see if the AI would highlight bias and address it on its own with ways to mitigate it and promote fairness, and with the second I dug deeper to see how the AI would actively work to take steps against bias and promote fairness.*
	5. Privacy & Data Security	How will you protect student data and maintain their confidentiality? How will you ensure their information stays within the school's network

		and does not leak outside of the school's network system? *I specifically chose not to guide AI to certain data and privacy policies to see if they would bring the policies up themselves and learn what the tool already has in place for the security of students and privacy of their data.*
	6. Transparency & Explainability	To make a lesson plan such as this, where is the training data being pulled from? Can you show me the internal workings/functioning of how you would make a choice to show students a particular example, and how you came up with the lesson plan above? What documentation are you pulling from to provide these answers? What documentation would you pull from to provide tailored explanations to students? 2. What is the source documentation you are referencing to know what the APA guidelines are? *I sought out information how transparent the tool would be on its training data, what information it would provide on that data, what sources it used to know the guidelines provided were correct, and how transparent their implementation of the lessons and adjustments would be.*
	7. Accessibility	How would you support students with a spotty internet connection in rural areas, and those who need audio support (visually impaired), additional languages for those with English as a second language, or any other accessibility features or needs? (only used in Copilot because it forgot) This specifically applies to Copilot acting as the supplier of this training. *Focused on ADA assistance, connective tissues for students, language barriers, and left it open ended for the AI agent to provide additional resources for other accessibility features it may be able to provide.*

III. Practical & Operational Aspects	8. Cost & Value (ROI)	How much would be implementing this program cost? Provide a detailed breakdown of every cost to implement this program. How much time would it save teachers? What time would it give back to teachers, and how much savings would that provide the district? How much would this improve learning outcomes? How would the students know if their learning has improved? Would there be other factors, such as improved learning/educational confidence? *This prompt focuses on improvements for the school, for the teachers, and the students. It asks what the monetary costs are, the time costs, and the emotional costs to determine the Value and the Return on Investment of implementing this program.*
	9. Integration & Scalability	How do you integrate with other LMS systems? What are the steps to integrate with other systems? Which systems do you not integrate with? Do you support open Api calls? How much data can be imported into your system at once? Are there hourly, daily, weekly, or monthly limits? *This prompt tests the AI system to see if large amounts of school related information can be injected into the information quickly to form the boundaries and guidelines, we want the AI to use while teaching the students. It also tests to see if we can connect the AI system into the current school's infrastructure system. Can the students click on a link in a system like 'blackboard' or 'Brightspace' and be exactly where they need to be, or will it be more difficult for them to access?*
	10. Vendor Support & Updates	Does (AI Tool Name Here) offer readily available and timely technical support, additional resources on setting up education lessons within the portal, clear AI tool update schedules that do not disrupt learning times and objectives, and continuous training of their models to ensure the accuracy of the information provided while reducing bias and ensuring equity of the AI model? Would we have a dedicated support person, team, or extension to

		contact? How would we offer feedback on the platform, and how often is that feedback actually acted upon? *This final prompt requests knowledge on how the vendor will support. Is there consistent assistance, are they easy to access? Regarding updates, it asks if the updates will be known, not disrupt the learning cycle, and if they will be frequent enough to ensure consistent evolution of learning and striving to remove bias while improving equity.*

Appendix A

AI Tool Evaluation Rubric for Educators (10 Criteria)

This rubric helps educators assess AI tools based on their pedagogical suitability, technical capabilities, user experience, ethical considerations, and practical implications. Refer to pages 3-5 for a more detailed explanation of the rubric.

Scoring Guide: Each criterion can be assessed on a scale of 0 to 3:

- **3: Exceeds Expectations / Excellent** – The tool demonstrates strong alignment with best practices, offering superior performance or features in this area, with no discernible concerns.
- **2: Meets Expectations / Good** – The tool generally aligns with best practices; there may be minor areas for improvement, but it is mainly practical and suitable.
- **1: Needs Improvement / Concern** – The tool has significant gaps, potential issues, or underperformance in this area, requiring attention or mitigation strategies.
- **0: Serious Concern / Not Acceptable** – The tool has significant deficiencies, high risks, or is fundamentally unsuitable in this area, rendering it problematic for use.

Category	Criteria	Definition & Evaluation Focus	Score (0-3)
I. Pedagogical Relevance & Performance	1. Pedagogical Alignment & Usefulness	The extent to which the tool's AI capabilities support specific educational objectives and solve a defined problem for educators or students. Evaluation Focus: Clarity of objectives, match between AI functionalities and educational tasks, and potential for beneficial uses.	0-3
	2. Accuracy & Content Quality	The degree to which AI-generated content (text, images, code, etc.) is consistently correct, reliable, relevant, and meaningful. Evaluation Focus: Verifiability, absence of misinformation, and relevance of content.	0-3
	3. Ease of Use & User Experience	The simplicity and intuitiveness of the user interface, allowing for effective use with minimal training. Evaluation Focus: User-friendly interface, minimal learning curve, efficient task completion, and user satisfaction.	0-3
II. Ethical & Responsible AI	4. Bias Mitigation & Fairness	The extent to which the tool mitigates harmful biases and ensures equitable treatment across different groups.	0-3

		Evaluation Focus: Absence of stereotypical or discriminatory outputs, efforts to manage biases, and alignment with concepts of equality and justice.	
	5. Privacy & Data Security	The measures taken to protect user data, maintain confidentiality, and comply with privacy regulations. Evaluation Focus: Explicit privacy policy, use of encryption, and compliance with regulations like FERPA or HIPAA.	0-3
	6. Transparency & Explainability	The degree to which information about the AI system's mechanisms, outputs, and decision-making processes is available and understandable. Evaluation Focus: Clear documentation of training data and sources, and ability to understand how the AI functions.	0-3
	7. Accessibility	How easily users with diverse abilities can use the tool. Evaluation Focus: Support for screen readers, compliance with web accessibility standards, and ease of use for individuals with different needs.	0-3
III. Practical & Operational Aspects	8. Cost & Value (ROI)	The financial expense balanced against its quantifiable and qualitative benefits. Evaluation Focus: Transparency of costs (fees, setup) and expected return on investment in terms of time saved or improved learning outcomes.	0-3
	9. Integration & Scalability	The ability of the tool to integrate with existing systems and handle increasing amounts of work, data, or users without performance drops. Evaluation Focus: Compatibility with other software, availability of APIs, and performance with large user bases.	0-3
	10. Vendor Support & Updates	The availability and quality of technical support, customer service, and ongoing maintenance. Evaluation Focus: Access to support teams, responsiveness to feedback, and clear update schedules.	0-3

Evaluation Categories and Criteria

I. Pedagogical Relevance & Performance

1. Pedagogical Alignment & Usefulness:

- **Definition:** The extent to which the tool's intended purposes and AI capabilities directly support specific educational objectives, learning goals, or teaching needs. It should solve a defined problem for educators or students.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Clarity of objectives and use cases, match between AI functionalities (e.g., Machine Learning, Natural Language Processing) and the educational task, and potential for beneficial uses.
- **Score:** 0-3

2. Accuracy & Content Quality:

- **Definition:** The degree to which the AI-generated content (text, images, code, etc.) is consistently correct, reliable, relevant, and meaningful for the task. This includes the quality of its data sources and coverage.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Verifiability of information, absence of misinformation or erroneous outputs, and the relevance of content delivered. Trustworthy AI systems are fundamentally "Valid & Reliable".
- **Score:** 0-3

3. Ease of Use & User Experience:

- **Definition:** The simplicity and intuitiveness of the user interface and overall experience allow educators and students to navigate and effectively use the tool with minimal training. This encompasses effectiveness, efficiency, and user satisfaction.
- **Evaluation Focus:** User-friendly interface, minimal learning curve, efficient task completion, and reported user satisfaction. Issues such as prolonged response times and insufficient features can negatively impact the user experience.
- **Score:** 0-3

II. Ethical & Responsible AI

4. Bias Mitigation & Fairness:

- **Definition:** The extent to which the AI tool exhibits or mitigates harmful biases in its outputs and ensures equitable treatment across different groups or individuals.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Absence of stereotypical or discriminatory outputs, efforts to manage systemic, computational, and human-cognitive biases, and alignment with concepts of equality, equity, and justice.
- **Score:** 0-3

5. Privacy & Data Security:

- **Definition:** The measures taken to protect user data, maintain confidentiality, and comply with relevant privacy regulations. This characteristic is vital for "Privacy-Enhanced" AI systems.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Access to and explicitness of the privacy policy, use of encryption and access controls, and compliance with regulations such as FERPA or HIPAA.
- **Score:** 0-3

6. Transparency & Explainability:

- **Definition:** The degree to which information about the AI system's mechanisms, outputs, and decision-making processes is available and understandable to users. This allows users to gain deeper insights into its functionality and trustworthiness.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Clear documentation of training data and source information, ability to understand how the AI functions and why it made a particular prediction or recommendation, and tailored explanations for users.
- **Score:** 0-3

7. Accessibility:

- **Definition:** How easily users with diverse abilities and from various locations can use the AI tool.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Support for screen readers, compliance with web accessibility standards, and general ease of use for individuals with different needs.
- **Score:** 0-3

III. Practical & Operational Aspects

8. Cost & Value (Return on Investment):

- **Definition:** The financial expense associated with acquiring and using the AI tool, balanced against its quantifiable and qualitative benefits.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Transparency of subscription fees, setup, and add-on costs, assessment of expected ROI in terms of time saved, cost reduction, or improved learning outcomes.
- **Score:** 0-3

9. Integration & Scalability:

- **Definition:** The ability of the AI tool to seamlessly integrate with existing systems and platforms (e.g., learning management systems, other software) and to handle increasing amounts of work, data, or users without performance drops.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Compatibility with other software, availability of API options, ease of integration with existing technological infrastructure, and performance with large datasets or user bases.
- **Score:** 0-3

10. Vendor Support & Updates:

- **Definition:** The availability and quality of technical support, customer service, and ongoing maintenance, including the frequency and transparency of updates.
- **Evaluation Focus:** Access to technical support teams and resources, responsiveness to feedback, clear update schedules for the AI tool, training data, and source information, and mechanisms for continuous monitoring and improvement.
- **Score:** 0-3